



The Selectboard
TOWN OF WESTHAMPTON
TOWN HALL
1 SOUTH ROAD
WESTHAMPTON, MASSACHUSETTS 01027

Minutes of the Meeting
Wednesday, April 27, 2026, 7:00 PM
at the Town Hall, 1 South Road

Call to Order

The meeting was called to order at 7:02 P.M.

PRESENT: Susan Bronstein (chair), Scott Johndrow, Jennifer Milikowsky.

Department Heads: Police Chief White, Sargent Jeff Fish, Fire Chief Dave Antosz, Highway Superintendent Bill Jablonski

Discussion on FY2027 Budget

Tad gave an overview of the current budget:

\$ 330,000 deficit after cuts

\$ 45,000 unapproved revenue from Elementary School Savings

leaving a \$ 285,000 current deficit.

Department Heads addressed the line items of their budgets that finance needed input on:

Police Dept.

\$58,962 adjusted for COLA is \$61,588 for Sargent and 1 patrol officer at current hours. Chief Salary of \$40,063 already includes COLA.

Police cruiser at \$75,000 is on the warrant for Annual Town Meeting and was scheduled to come out of Free Cash. Chief White pointed out that it is on the Capital Schedule for this year and he is concerned about repair cost on the current vehicle. Tad suggested that the only way to pay for it would be out of Stabilization.

Fire Dept.

EMS coordinator does all the training for first responders. Without this position, the fire dept. would have to go outside for training at \$100 per volunteer and this would not cover other responsibilities of the position. Chief Antosz agreed that they could accept the reduction of the Emergency Management Service line item to \$6,000. Chief Antosz mentioned that equipment costs keep going up. He received \$10,500 in grant money that only paid for new gear for 3 firefighters. He did not have an exact number but said that the town receives many hours of volunteer service from the department.

Highway Dept.

The reduction to \$11,500 on the **Administration** line item would put training of staff at risk. The **Highway Salaries** line item was discussed and the need to retain the 4th crew member was discussed at length. Mr. Jablonski emphasized the difficulties they would experience without this replacement. Suggestions were made to hire part-time persons or hire someone to mow the cemetery. Mr. Jablonski also discussed how additional paperwork for Chapter 90 and grant applications support the need of the **Highway Clerk** position. **Highway Materials, Road**

Machinery and Road Machinery Buildings line items were discussed.

Town Administrator and Town Clerk line items were discussed with no motions made.

Reserve Fund line item was left at \$25,000 with a reminder from Doug that it can not be used to “back fund” budgets. It is only for unanticipated expenses.

Following Dept head discussions, Tad made the suggestion that we ask the Elementary School to take an additional \$40,000 from savings and split the remaining deficit into a \$125,000 override and \$125,000 from Free Cash.

After much more discussion on how to address an override, the following was suggested by finance committee members:

Take: \$10,000 from **Materials** line item in Highway

\$10,000 from the **Highway Clerk** line item

\$15,000 from the **Elementary School**

\$125,000 from **Free Cash**

\$125,000 from an **Override**

This would cover the \$285,000 deficit in the budget.

COLA

It was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow

To recommend a 2.5% Cost of Living Adjustment for all employees for the 2027 fiscal year.

VOTED 3, 0, 0 (9:55 PM)

ADJOURN

It was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow

To Adjourn

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (9:56 PM)

Approved by a vote of the Selectboard on May 4, 2026.



Susan Bronstein



Scott Johndrow



Jennifer Milikowsky